

PROJECT 1

THE EMPATHY MAP

Understanding the User Before We Design



SCENARIO

A new fitness startup wants to launch an app for busy office professionals who struggle to find time for exercise. Before designing a single pixel, the team needs to understand the "User's Pain."



TARGET AUDIENCE



Age
25 - 45 Years



Location
Urban Areas



Profession
Office Professionals
(IT, Managers, Consultants,
Corporate Employees)



Characteristics

- Long working hours
- Sedentary lifestyle
- Health-conscious but inconsistent
- Limited time for fitness
- Depend on mobile apps



Work Style
Hybrid / Remote / Office



USER PERSONA



Arjun Kumar

29 Years
Software Engineer
Chennai

"I want to stay fit, but my work schedule leaves me with very little time to exercise."

GOALS

- ✓ Maintain a healthy lifestyle
- ✓ Lose excess weight
- ✓ Improve energy levels
- ✓ Exercise regularly

FRUSTRATIONS

- ✗ Lack of time for gym visits
- ✗ Irregular workout routine
- ✗ Difficulty staying motivated
- ✗ Long hours sitting at a desk

EMPATHY MAP



SEE

- Fitness advertisements on social media
- Colleagues discussing health & fitness
- Health tracking apps
- Online workout videos
- Fitness influencers



THINK

- I should start exercising regularly
- My health is becoming a concern
- I need a fitness solution that fits my schedule
- Traditional gym routines take too much time



FEEL

- Stressed due to workload
- Guilty about not exercising
- Concerned about long-term health
- Motivated but overwhelmed
- Frustrated by lack of consistency



SAY

- "I don't have enough time."
- "I'll start exercising next week."
- "I need something quick and effective."
- "My work schedule is too demanding."



DO

- Watches fitness content online
- Downloads fitness apps
- Occasionally goes for walks
- Attempts workout plans but stops midway
- Searches for quick exercise routines



PAIN POINTS

- ! Busy work schedules leave little time for exercise
- ! Lack of motivation and self-discipline
- ! Difficulty maintaining consistency
- ! Long screen time and sedentary habits
- ! Lack of personalized fitness guidance
- ! Limited access to convenient workout options



KEY INSIGHTS

- ✓ Users need short and effective workouts
- ✓ Personalized plans increase engagement
- ✓ Reminders and motivation help maintain consistency
- ✓ Progress tracking keeps users committed
- ✓ Stress relief and mental wellness are important
- ✓ Flexibility is the key for busy professionals



DESIGN OPPORTUNITIES

- 10-15 Minute Quick Workouts
- Personalized Fitness Plans
- Smart Notifications & Reminders
- Progress Dashboard & Tracking
- Office-Friendly Exercises
- Stress Relief Activities
- Goal-Based Challenges



PROJECT OUTCOME

A clear understanding of the user before moving to design.

This will help us create a fitness app that is **intuitive, relevant and truly solves** the user's problems.

